

We'll detail the process for jailbreaking the latest release of iOS -- iOS 5.1.1. Fortunately, this jailbreak is untethered, which means you would not have to run to your nearest PC to restart or switch on your iPhone.

The tool required to jailbreak an iOS 5.1.1 device is called "Absinthe," and is available for the PC, Mac and Linux. Although the screenshots show a Windows version of the tool running, instructions for Mac and Linux are the same.

Before proceeding to the actual jailbreak instructions please make sure you are on iOS 5.1.1. You can do this by opening the Settings app, navigating to General>About and seeing the value in the "Version" field. In case you are not on iOS 5.1.1, fire up iTunes and upgrade your iPhone or better still, update iOS over-the-air by navigating to General>Software Update in the Settings app.

Once you're done with that, as a measure of precaution, back up your iPhone to iTunes or iCloud depending on what preferences you have set. During the whole process, make sure that your iPhone remains plugged in to your Mac or PC. Also fair warning, as you might have guessed, Apple isn't very fond of jailbreaking, and if you take a jailbroken device to its stores they might refuse to address your problem. You might void your warranty. But once you remove all traces of a jailbreak by a clean restore, your phone should be the same as anyone else's. We'll also give you instructions on how to "clean restore" your iPhone.

Step one:

Download Absinthe from the following URLs, depending on your OS.

Windows : <http://dgit.in/KRAS7b>

Mac : <http://dgit.in/MK2lZj>

Linux : <http://dgit.in/LbnQOI>

Step two:

Once you're done downloading the file, install it at your favourite location. Windows users, unzip the file, navigate to the unzipped location and simply click on the Absinthe executable file. It should pop up a command line window with lots of text scrolling. Let it do its thing, and terminate by itself. Once it's done, you'll notice another folder in the same directory as the executable. Go into this folder.

Step three:

Launch the Absinthe executable file, and you should be presented with a